Why Is Descriptive Writing Important?

Once you master descriptive writing, you can apply it to any exam. All you need is a clear understanding of the approach and technique.

Talking specifically about the RBI exam:

1. **High Weightage**
   Descriptive carries 200 out of 300 marks:
   - FM – 50 marks
   - ESI – 50 marks
   - English – 100 marks
2. **More Reliable Than Objective**
   Objective papers can be unpredictable, with odd or unexpected questions. In descriptive, even a well-structured generic answer can help you score above average.
3. **Boosts Mains Score**
   A strong descriptive performance significantly increases your overall mains score and strengthens your chances of final selection.
4. **Builds Thinking and Confidence**
   Descriptive writing is an art. It improves your ability to think, process ideas, and express opinions clearly. This naturally boosts confidence and helps you present structured, point-wise answers—skills that are extremely useful in the interview stage.
5. **Helps Across Multiple Exams**
   Once you master descriptive writing, you can attempt other exams with the same level of preparation, without starting from scratch.
6. **Easy Marks in English**
   With the right technique, you don't need extra preparation for English. Scoring **65+ marks** becomes achievable and consistent.

What should you do first when you see a question?

When a question appears on the screen or paper, many aspirants begin to panic. Your heartbeat rises, your mind becomes blank and stress takes over. This reaction is normal as it does not indicate whether you are weak or strong, intelligent or dull. It is simply a human nature.

Step 1: Pause and Breathe
Before writing anything, take **a deep breath** and give your mind **1–2 minutes of space** to settle. A calm mind will understand the question far better than a stressed one.

Step 2: Read the Question Multiple Times
Read the question **twice or even thrice**. A common mistake is that students misunderstand the question and write something completely different from what is asked.
Your aim is to *grasp the demand* of the question.

Step 3: Break the Question into Parts
Once you understand the question, break it into **logical components**.
Example question:
"Critically analyse the statement: 'The Tendulkar poverty line is a destitution line, not a poverty line.' How does the Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) provide a better understanding of poverty compared to income-based measures?" (600 words)

This can be broken down into **two major sections**:
i) Tendulkar Committee and its Poverty Line
You may include:

- Background & purpose of the committee
- Key recommendations
- Strengths & positive impacts
- Criticisms and limitations
- Relevance in today's context

ii) Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI)
You may include:

- What MPI measures
- Dimensions and indicators
- Why it is broader than income-based poverty lines
- Strengths and limitations
- Global and Indian relevance

2) How to Write the Introduction
A good introduction should be:

- **Concise**
- **Directly related to the topic**
- **Not more than 10% of the total word limit**

For a 600-word answer, the introduction should be about **50–60 words**.
For the sample question, you may:

- Start by defining **poverty**
- Give a brief line on **Tendulkar poverty line** and **MPI**
- Set the context for the analysis

3) How to Write the Conclusion
You already have shared guidelines on conclusions https://t.me/c/3416715048/150

A good conclusion should:

- Summarize your analysis
- Reflect balance
- Provide a forward-looking viewpoint or policy suggestion

It should be around **50–60 words**.

4) What If You Know Nothing About the Topic? (Adverse Scenario)

Here's what you should do:

a) Write a basic introduction

You *always* know something general about the theme. Even if you don't know about Tendulkar or MPI, you know what **poverty** is.

That alone can give you a decent 40–60-word introduction.

b) Write a basic conclusion

A conclusion can be generic, emphasizing balanced policymaking, data-driven approaches, welfare prioritization, etc.

Between intro and conclusion, you have covered **120 words**.

c) Break the Question as Usual

Even if you don't know specifics, divide the question into two main parts:

- **Part 1: Tendulkar Committee (write generic concepts)**
  If you don't know details, write about:
  - Income-based poverty lines
  - Possible limitations of single-parameter measurement
  - Why some poverty lines may underestimate deprivation

- **Part 2: MPI (write generic concepts)**
  Even without technical knowledge, you can write about:
  - Multi-dimensional nature of poverty
  - Non-income factors: education, health, living conditions
  - Why broader indicators give a clearer picture

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d) Word Distribution

For a 600-word question:

- **250 words** on Tendulkar (generic but logical)
- **250 words** on MPI (generic but logical)

This means:

- You meet the word limit
- Your answer stays structured
- You do not leave the page blank

Next Step: What To Do in the Initial 2 Minutes

Now that you understand the structure of how to approach a descriptive answer, let's return to the moment when you first saw the question, when you took those **2 minutes to calm your mind**.

What exactly should you do in that time?

1. Think of the Topic and the Structure

Once your mind settles, start thinking **sequentially** about the basic structure:

- **Introduction**
- **Body**
- **Conclusion**

This mental framework itself gives clarity and direction.

2. Note Down Whatever Comes to Your Mind
If a few ideas or phrases come to you, whether for the introduction, the body, or the conclusion **pick up a pen and jot down the broad points**.

These are not final sentences. These are **themes** that will guide your answer.
Many aspirants underestimate themselves.
But remember:
You already know how to tell stories.
Give anyone a mic and ask them to speak about a random topic, they can go on for 15–20 minutes, effortlessly.
This same skill applies to writing.
If you can speak on a topic, you can *write* on it too.

3. Gather Your Thoughts, Then Start Writing
After noting down the raw ideas, **do not rush** into writing paragraphs.
First, give your mind a moment of **comfort and relaxation**.
Tell yourself: *"I'm ready. I know enough to start."*
This mental preparation is important.

4. Why This Mental Reset Matters
A good speaker always tests the mic by saying, "Mic check, mic check."
Why?
Because this is his **riyaaz**, his warm-up.
Similarly, you also need a warm-up before writing.
This warm-up is not about writing the perfect introduction; it's about **getting mentally comfortable**.

Think of a cricketer.
He doesn't walk onto the pitch and hit a six on the very first ball.
He takes time to understand the pitch, feel the bat, and build confidence.
Writing is the same.
You need:

- A few breaths
- A few rough notes
- A few seconds of alignment

And then the confidence naturally builds.

How to Connect Points When You Can't Think of an Answer

No matter how prepared you are, there will always be moments during the exam when your mind goes blank. You understand the question but nothing substantial comes to your mind.
This is where **broader themes** come in.
These are universal ideas that can be connected to **almost any topic** and they fit naturally because they influence every major sector of governance and society.
If you know a few major schemes, indices and data points related to these themes, you can use them anywhere.

We will learn this approach through an example

1. Women Empowerment as a Universal Connecting Theme
If you are aware of women-centric schemes or issues related to gender equality, you can connect them across a wide range of topics.

Example Uses:
a) Poverty
Women are one of the most vulnerable sections.
You can include:

- Gender Gap Index data

- Female labour force participation
- Women-headed households and poverty
- Government schemes targeted at women's economic upliftment

b) Entrepreneurship

Women's participation in entrepreneurship is rising but still limited.
You can mention:

- Share of women in MSMEs
- Stand-Up India, Mudra Yojana, etc.
- Digital literacy initiatives enabling women-led enterprises

c) Agriculture

Women form a major portion of the agricultural workforce, yet remain invisible.
You can write about:

- Feminization of agriculture
- Access to land rights
- Women in agri-value chains
- SHGs involved in agri-allied activities

d) Unemployment

Women face:

- Higher unemployment rates
- Lower labour force participation
- Skill gaps
- Social and cultural barriers

e) Education

You can connect women's education to:

- Human capital
- Reduced fertility rates
- Improved health outcomes
- Better economic productivity

Schemes like Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao can also be used.

f) Health

Here, you can link to:

- Maternal mortality
- Anaemia among women
- Reproductive health
- Access to institutional healthcare
- Women-specific health programs

Useful in any health-related question.

g) Indian Economy

Women's participation affects:

- GDP growth
- Demographic dividend
- Skilling
- Entrepreneurship ecosystem
- Formal and informal labour markets

Why This Works

Themes like **women empowerment**, **digital inclusion**, **climate change**, **governance**, **technology**, etc (we have already covered in our fodder material) are universal.
They don't look forced when used properly because these factors truly impact every sector.

Your target in an exam is not to write a perfect academic paper but to show layered thinking.
If you can naturally connect one broader theme with the question, your answer:

- becomes richer
- looks multidimensional
- shows awareness of governance and society
- stands out from generic writing

Next Stage: Integrating Points Across Any Subject & Training Your Mind

The ability to connect ideas is not limited to ESI or themes like women empowerment.
In **Finance, Management, and even English descriptive writing**, you can (and should) integrate points from one concept to another.
This gives your answers **depth, flow, and multidimensionality**.
But even with all this knowledge, there will be moments when:

- Your mind suddenly stops
- You can't think beyond a point
- You start looking around
- You feel the urge to check your phone or the internet
- You go blank and lose track

This is normal *and this is exactly where your training matters.*

1. The Most Important Rule: Write Something
When you blank out, the worst thing you can do is freeze.
The best thing you can do is **put words on the board**.
Your descriptive answers are evaluated on multiple parameters:

- Weightage of sections
- Depth of content
- Richness of points
- Relevance to the theme
- Grammar and clarity
- Flow and presentation

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These may not be officially declared RBI parameters, but based on:

- Years of experience
- Topper discussions
- Paper analysis
- Standard evaluation practices

…it is clear that evaluation is multi-dimensional.
This means:

- Even an imperfect answer earns marks.
- Even a partially correct structure helps.
- Even simple sentences score when presented well.

So do not fear being wrong.
Do not fear losing marks.
Fill the paper.

2. When You Can't Think Beyond a Point — Train Your Brain
If your mind gets stuck and refuses to think further:

- Don't stare at the screen
- Don't look for a cheat sheet
- Don't panic

Instead, **train your brain to push through the blockage**.
Your brain begins to work only when you **force it to work**.

You must convince your mind that this is the moment for effort.
You have to break the limitation, penetrate the wall, and push yourself forward.
This requires:

- **Focus**
- **Perseverance**
- **Repeated practice**

And sometimes, it even requires:

- Writing poorly
- Writing incomplete sentences
- Writing something that feels absurd

This is okay.
Because **your technique is more important than the quality in the beginning**.

3. Focus on Technique, Not Outcome
The conclusion is simple:
✓ **Master the technique**
✗ **Don't worry about the result right now**
Outcome is not immediate.
Good writing is a long-term reward.
It takes repeated cycles of writing badly, adjusting, improving, and practising before you see mastery.
There are no shortcuts.
You cannot escape this stage but you can **succeed** by following:

- the right method,
- the right structure,
- and the right technique we have discussed so far.

That is the only way to grow.

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Note
We have intentionally not discussed minute details such as:

- the specific examples to be added in Management answers,
- the exact word limits for Precis or RC,
- or the micro-level structuring of subject-specific questions.

Here, our focus has been on the **broader approach**, the **general technique** and the **overall mindset** required for writing effective descriptive answers.
All the finer details such as examples, templates, subject-specific structures, word-limit strategies and advanced techniques can be discussed separately in the **closed group**, where we can address them more deeply and personally.

India has entered the top 100 countries in the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) Index for the first time, ranking 99th in 2025. Critically examine India's progress in achieving the SDGs, highlighting key government initiatives across sectors such as health, education, energy, and biodiversity. What factors have contributed to India's improved ranking? (620 words)
OR
Despite improvements, India and other developing countries face several challenges in achieving SDGs, including climate finance gaps, pandemics, environmental pressures, and global conflicts. Discuss the major impediments to SDG implementation and suggest comprehensive strategies, including governance reforms, financing mechanisms, and local-level actions, to accelerate India's progress toward 2030 targets. (620 words)

Learner Answer:
The Brundtland Commission in their 1987 report titled " Our common future" exaplained sustainable development as "The development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of the future generations to meet their own needs". It ensures economic, environmental as well as social development of the country.
India recently entered the top 100 of SDG Index for the first time ranking 99th with a score of 66.95. This indicates a milestone for India as it has progressed leaps and bounds, becoming one of the fastest developing countries. India's progress in achieving SDG goals is supplemented by various government initiatives spread across various sectors. These include-
A) Healthcare-
India has significantly improved in this sector with substantial improvement in key indicators such as Maternal Mortality Rate and Infant Mortality rate. Schemes like National health mission and Janani Suraksha Yojana help in this regard. Various other government initiatives such as PM Ayushman Bharat Yojana, which provides free healthcare insurance upto 5 lakhs and Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana which provide maternity benefits help in improvement of healthcare.

data could be mentioned

very general statement to introduce the sector.

B) Education-
Education is highly important sector for a developing countrty like India with A demographic advantage. Proper education reforms become essential for growth. Schemes like PM ULLAS ensure foundational and numerical literacy whereas PM SHRI ensures sustainable infrastructre of schools. PM POSHAAN known as the mid day meal scheme ensure enrollment remains high especially in the rural areas.

vague statement

unneccessarily lengthy sentence

C) Energy-
India's dependence on fossil fuels had become a huge threat for the country's development but slowly India is becoming a sustainable powerhouse reducing dependence on them and inculcating renewable energy into daily lives. The priority sector lending norms help the renewable sector to develop whereas the Sovereign Green Bonds help in green financing. Schemes like PM KUSUM and PM SURYA GHAR MUFT BIJLI YOJANA help the individuals in adapting sustainable measures.

D) Biodiversity-
India has been always known for its flora and fauna and protecting it becomes a crucial task. Schemes like Amrit Sarovar Ponds help in creating lakes in the rural parts of the country. Ramsar wetland sites are highly protected. National biodiversity parks are also looked afted with careful surveillance.

Therefore in conclusion, sustainable development is not just another goal it has become civilizational necessity. It ensures that economic growth does not come at the cost of ecologicla collapse and social exclusion. India's philosophy of 'Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam' that is the World is One helps in maintaining global sustainability standard. According to Mahatma Gandhi "The world has enough for every man's need but not for every mans greed.". This statement indicates sustainable growth, growth that lasts, improves and heals.

unneccessary - Gandhiji's quote

sentences are changing abruptly.No mention of progress or any schemes.

Time Taken: 25 min
Word count: 439

S. No.	Criteria	Total marks	Your marks	Remarks
1	Content, relevance and accuracy	5	1.5	Intro – Intro is good which includes an overview of India in the newly launched index and also the purpose of the report. Body – No facts and figures to show the progress of any sector. It would have strengthened the answer. No details on India's improvement. Schemes mentioned are very limited and with very generic objective - "PM KUSUM and PM SURYA GHAR MUFT BIJLI YOJANA help the individuals in adapting sustainable measures" 1.Mention the full form 2.Mention the objective of the scheme in brief not a general idea. The second part of the question has not been addressed. "The factors contributing in India's improved ranking." Conclusion is okay. Can be improved.
2	Structure and Logical flow	3	1.5	Answer follows the IBC structure except that one part of the question is unanswered. A flow is missing from the answer. "Schemes like PM ULLAS ensure foundational and numerical literacy whereas PM SHRI ensures sustainable infrastructre of schools. PM POSHAAN known as the mid day meal scheme ensure enrollment remains high especially in the rural areas." Here the schemes looks scattered.
3	Depth of analysis	3	0.25	Some sentences are very generic and some are extreme. No critical analysis regarding the progress in India , the schemes undergoing and how are they helping in attaining the SDG objective. No sector linked to the SDG goal.
4	Language and clarity	2	1.25	Some spelling mistakes. Language is clear but some sentences are very general.
5	Presentation and Word limit	2	1.25	Short of word limit. With subheadings the answer looks presentable.
Total		15	5.75	

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The Stand-Up India Scheme has not only financed enterprises but also fostered social inclusion and gender equity. Analyse how the Stand-Up India Scheme has contributed to inclusive entrepreneurship in India. What more can be done to deepen its impact on SC/ST and women-led enterprises? (620 words)

Answer:

Stand Up India scheme is a government scheme being run by Ministry of Finance, wherein it is mandatory for every scheduled commercial bank to extend a loan of minimum 1 crore to one woman one SC/ST beneficiary. This loan is collateral free and provided only for greenfield projects at a concessional rate of interest. This scheme is working towards increasing economic participation of marginalised section of the society. This scheme besides financing enterprises, has also fostered social inclusion and gender equity in following ways.

1. Inclusion of marginalised community- This scheme includes at least one SC or one ST community beneficiary to be covered by every bank. It helps them to float their innovative ideas without any financial constraint or being dependent on other sections of the society.
2. Seperate criteria for women- By mandating inclusion of at least one woman other than SC/ST, this scheme works towards gender equity. It is so because most of the women in our society lack ownership rights and hence are unable to avail funds from formal sources.
3. Inclusive employment opportunities- This scheme indirectly promotes employment in socio-economically backward section by creating employers out of their community. A SC/ST member is more likely to hire employees from their community and hence will help in increasing labour force participation rate.
4. Increasing financial literacy- Since, most of the banking activities are processed through digital means, SC/ST and women by coming under purview of this scheme, also get to know more about emerging these channels. They also become more financially aware. *these emerging*

Further, this scheme has also contributed to inclusive entrepreneurship in India is following ways- *in the following ways*
1. Support to green-field ventures- This scheme includes only new projects and hence encourages beneficiaries to come up with new and innovative ideas. Thus entrepreneurship can be promoted in remotest and left out corners of the country.
2. Monitoring end use of funds- Banks in order to maitain their financial health are also required to consider prudential lending norms and monitor end use of funds. This way to ensure recovery of their loans and prevent them from becoming NPA (Non-Performing Assets), banks also extend certain guidance and support to them.

However, despite being launched in 2016, this scheme still needs to deepen its impact on the beneficiary groups. This can be done in following ways-
1. Increasing awareness- Most of the actual beneficiaries, lack awareness about availability of such formal lending facility. As a result, a large part of fund fails to reach the actual beneficiary. Further, in many cases, the funds get misallocated as often men take loans in names of their wives further denying them their access right in the business.
2. Identify gaps- The gaps in the implementation of scheme at ground level needs to be identified. This can be done by using a combination of digital and physical means. Intermediaries like business correspondents, and Self-Help Groups can be engaged to monitor end use of funds being dispatched and identify the areas where the business opportunities are lacking.
3. Providing subsequent loans- For the ventures which become successful and beneficiaries who are able to repay their loans in time should be given access to further borrowing. This loan should also be provided at a subsidised rate and without collateral. This would act as incentive for them.

Therefore, Stand Up India scheme is one of the landmark schemes which is playing an important role in promoting gender equality and inclusive development. Though there are certain gaps, but they can be identified with the collaborative efforts of government, private sector institutions, banks, and local bodies. This identification can make this scheme a grand successs.

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Time Taken:
17m 11s

Word Count:
606

Feedback and Suggestions:

1. Intro is very good and perfectly framed. You've given basic info about the scheme and the eligibility criteria, which is what was expected in the intro. However, there should be some minor changes to make it stronger. The loan amount is not minimum 1 crore but ranges from 10 lakhs to 1 crore. You could've also mentioned the rate of interest (Base rate+ 3%+ Tenor premium).

2. In the first part of the body, the point "Inclusive employment opportunities" is good but it can be presented in a better way by reframing. The statement "A SC/ST member is more likely to hire employees from their community" sounds generalized and presumptuous. It can be made stronger by reframing as-
"The scheme enhances employment opportunities as many of the supported entrepreneurs are small-scale, and hence they tend to employ individuals from similar socio-economic backgrounds, thereby fostering inclusive and community-based job creation."

3. The point, "Monitoring end use of funds" is not specific to the scheme and rather general. The point can be made stronger by shifting the explanation to banks giving handholding support to the entrepreneurs. The point is good but just needs better structuring and explanation.

4. The conclusion is good, however it can be made stronger with some forward-looking statements, like suggestions or policy interventions.

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S. No.	Criteria	Total marks	Your marks	Remarks
1	Content, relevance and accuracy	5	4	The content and the points presented are excellent. However, the answer lacks data to validate the points and their explanation.
2	Structure and Logical flow	3	2.5	Overall, the structuring is fair. The answer breaks the flow at some places.
3	Depth of analysis	3	2	The answer goes in required depth of the key points, however some pointers lack the same due to the explanation not being correctly framed.
4	Language and clarity	2	1	Grammar, spelling and punctuation errors need to be improved.
5	Presentation and Word limit	2	2	Reaches the required word limit with equitable distribution of words. Presentation is also good.
Total		15	11.5	

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